

DCS MISSION STARTER

USER GUIDE

Pick a map, an era, and an aircraft — fly a living world in minutes.
Airfields dressed. SAMs up. The strike group at sea. No waypoints, ever.

Welcome aboard

Select, don't search. The DCS Mission Starter builds a living world for you: airfields dressed with period-correct aircraft and equipment, working SAM sites, support flights on station, and a carrier strike group with a properly spotted deck. You download a ready **.miz** file and build *your* mission on top in the DCS Mission Editor.

We set the stage — you write the play. The Starter never places your waypoints. Flight planning is always yours.

Quick start

- **1.** Open the wizard and pick a **map** and an **era**. The era is a hard filter: a WWII starter will not offer a Hornet, and a modern starter will not offer a Spitfire.
- **2.** Pick your **side, home airfield, and aircraft** — the full DCS flyable roster, filtered to the period. Choose single-player or multiplayer slots, start type, time, weather.
- **3.** Toggle **building blocks**. Everything is optional; defaults are sensible.
- **4.** Optionally pick a **template pack** (e.g. Backseat Ops for the F-4E).
- **5. Generate.** Drop the **.miz** in *Saved Games/DCS/Missions/* and fly, or open it in the Mission Editor and keep building.
- **6. Share.** “Copy share link” gives you a URL that regenerates this exact starter for anyone who clicks it. Paste it in your squadron Discord.

The standard comm ladder

Every starter uses the same predefined comms, so you learn the plan once. The ladder is printed on the in-jet kneeboard and in the mission briefing.

AGENCY	CALLSIGN	FREQ (UHF)	TACAN	NOTES
Guard	—	243.00	—	monitored
Your flight	(varies)	305.00	—	flight common
Tactical	—	254.00	—	inter-flight coordination
AWACS	Overlord	251.00	—	land-based E-3 / A-50
Tanker	Texaco	253.00	39Y	speeds & altitudes per type
Carrier	Mother	264.00	71X	ICLS 11 · Link4 336 · ACLS on
CAP	(squadron)	258.00	—	carrier air wing
AEW Hawkeye	(squadron)	259.00	—	carrier air wing
FARPs	(name)	127.50+	—	0.25 steps per pad

All carrier approach systems come pre-activated — TACAN 71X “STN”, ICLS channel 11, Link4 on 336, and ACLS. Tune and go.

Building blocks

BLOCK	WHAT YOU GET
Airfield dressing	Era- and faction-correct static aircraft on real parking stands, ground support equipment, fuel farms, tents, com
Air defenses	Complete, functional SAM sites with doctrinal layouts — SA-2/3/6/11, Hawk, Patriot by era and side — plus SH
Tanker / AWACS	On station behind friendly lines on the standard freqs. Not available in WWII — the era gate is strict.
Carrier strike group	A real CSG with a doctrine-spotted deck. See the next section.
Ambient air traffic	AI transports starting up and flying between friendly fields.
Functional FARPs	Pads with the fuel, ammo, command, and comms vehicles required for rearm and refuel to actually work.
Strike targets	Depot, convoy, and C2 packages in the enemy rear — each with a trigger zone ready for your own mission log
Practice range	Bombing ring and strafe line in the friendly rear.
Nav kneeboard	Comms card, airfield data, and a theater overview rendered into the jet's kneeboard.

The carrier strike group

Pick a hull and you get its **real strike group**. The Roosevelt sails as CSG-9 with USS Lake Erie (CG-70) and DESRON 23 destroyers; the Truman as CSG-8 with USS Gettysburg; the Forrestal as a 1980s Mediterranean battle group with USS Ticonderoga. Screen stations follow doctrine: plane-guard destroyer astern, AAW cruiser on the beam, pickets on the bow quarters. The group steams into wind on BRC.

Deck configuration

DECK STATE	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE
Recovery	Landing area clear (angle, waist cats, EL4, port stern). The bow is the pack: tight uniform herringbone rows across t
Launch	Cats, JBDs, and taxi flow clear; spares spotted aft in uniform rows.
Packed	Port-visit deck. Everything fouled including the angle. No-fly.

Check the aircraft types you want on deck — rows are spotted one squadron per row, with tugs, MJ-1 loaders, and crash gear at their real stations. Optionally launch the air wing's **CAP** (two-ship on the threat axis at 25,000 ft — e.g. VFA-146 Blue Diamonds) and an **E-2 Hawkeye** AEW orbit covering the force.

Template packs

- **Backseat Ops: IZLID Designation (F-4E)** — you fly the back seat; Iceman flies the jet and Jester lases a convoy with the IZLID on a scripted timeline.
- **Backseat Ops: GCI Intercept (F-4E, experimental)** — Iceman holds CAP, GCI commits you onto inbound Backfires; you run the intercept from the pit.

Templates are the one exception to the no-waypoints rule — the AI pilot needs steerpoints to fly.

Share links and recipes

A starter is defined by its **recipe** — your wizard selections plus a seed. Share links encode the recipe, not the file: the same link always regenerates the same mission, even after DCS updates. Change the seed to reroll the details while keeping your selections.

FAQ

The mission won't load or units are missing. Make sure you own the map. Carrier decks with CVN-71/72/73/75 need the Supercarrier module; the Stennis deck works in the base game, and the Forrestal comes with the F-14.

Can I edit the starter? Yes — that's the point. Open it in the Mission Editor; everything is ordinary groups and statics you can move, delete, or build on.

Why can't I pick aircraft X in era Y? Hard era gate by service window — the Hornet entered service in 1987, so it can't appear in a Cold War (1965–1985) starter. This keeps every starter period-authentic.